

Human-Factor-Coupled Collision Avoidance and Search-and-Rescue in a Multi-Agent Maritime Safety Simulation: A Baltic–North Sea Case Study

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Abstract

Between 70–96 % of maritime casualties involve human error [1], and adverse weather compounds it by degrading both perception and the very communications crews rely on to coordinate avoidance. We present a tick-based maritime agent-based model on the real Baltic and North Sea, in which vessels follow hand-authored shipping tracks and resolve encounters through a Closest-Point-of-Approach (CPA) detector coupled to a COLREGs-style give-way rule. The contribution is a quantified causal chain from *environmental and human degradation* to *collision outcome*: the success of every collision-warning exchange is gated by the product of local weather severity and a circadian crew-fatigue scalar, so tired watch-keepers in heavy weather miss warnings and collide. Collision consequences are evaluated with an accredited probabilistic damage model (DTU SIMCOL), external collision frequency is cross-validated against the regulator-grade IWRAP Mk II model, and a search-and-rescue subsystem layers IAMSAR random-search detection (MASSIM) with month-conditioned Arctic environmental degradation (Ashrafi). Against a classical and a weather-aware baseline, the system is evaluated across four scenarios with 30 seed-matched runs per condition using Mann–Whitney U tests with Holm–Bonferroni correction and Cliff’s δ effect sizes. We hypothesise that fatigue-aware watch scheduling reduces the fatal-event rate by ≥ 20 % and improves post-incident survival by ≥ 15 % relative to the classical baseline.

Index Terms: maritime safety, multi-agent systems, agent-based modelling, collision avoidance, human factors, search and rescue

1. Introduction

Maritime transport carries roughly 80 % of global trade, yet the sector’s safety record is dominated by a persistent human-error problem. The International Maritime Organization (IMO) attributes 70–96 % of all incidents to human causes [1], and the European Maritime Safety Agency (EMSA) identifies weather as a compounding factor in a disproportionate share of total-loss events, particularly in congested coastal corridors where crew fatigue and information latency interact [2]. Hull and machinery insurance claims exceed USD 3.5 billion annually [3]; even a 5 % reduction in fatal incidents would yield hundreds of millions in avoided liability.

The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (COLREGs) [4] provide a deterministic collision-avoidance baseline whose implicit assumption — that crews perceive the encounter geometry accurately and communicate intentions reliably — fails under two compounding conditions that prior agent-based maritime simulation [5, 6, 7] rarely couples directly to outcome:

- **Environmental degradation of communication.** Reduced visibility, sea clutter, and heavy weather degrade the bridge-to-bridge (VHF) exchanges through which two converging vessels agree who gives way. Most collision-avoidance models assume that, once a risk is detected, the manoeuvre is always executed.
- **Human-factor coupling.** Crew fatigue accumulates over watch cycles and follows a circadian pattern with a late-night performance nadir [8]. Prior models isolate fatigue in peripheral sub-models without a direct, quantified connection to whether a warning is acted upon.

The contribution of this work is a maritime agent-based model in which the success probability of every collision-warning exchange is the *product* of an environmental factor and a crew-fatigue factor, creating a quantified causal link from *information quality under stress* to *collision and survival outcomes*. We build the model on the real Baltic and North Sea geography (Section 3), drive vessels along hand-authored shipping tracks, and resolve encounters with a CPA/TCPA detector and a COLREGs-style give-way rule (Section 5). Collision consequences use the accredited DTU SIMCOL probabilistic damage model (Section 6); the resulting collision frequency is cross-validated against IWRAP Mk II (Section 7); and a search-and-rescue subsystem (Section 8) closes the loop from incident to survival. The engine is implemented in Rust on the krABMaga agent-based framework [9] for deterministic, data-parallel batch execution. Figure 1 summarises the causal pipeline that ties these components together.

2. Research Objectives

The central thesis is: *coupling crew-fatigue dynamics to the reliability of collision-warning communication, and managing fatigue through smart watch scheduling, reduces fatal maritime outcomes more effectively than weather-unaware classical practice.*

Experimental conditions. All experiments compare three methods, implemented as configuration switches over a single agent codebase:

Baseline A (Classical) represents current weather-unaware practice: vessels follow COLREGs give-way with idealised (perfect) VHF communication, no weather-induced slowdown, and an unmanaged fatigue build-up.

Baseline B (Shore Rest Alerts) adds weather-aware speed reduction and shore-issued rest advisories that slow fatigue accumulation, but no further mitigation.

Proposed System adds smart watch scheduling (lowest fatigue build-rate) on top of the weather-aware mitigations of Baseline B. Performance is measured using six

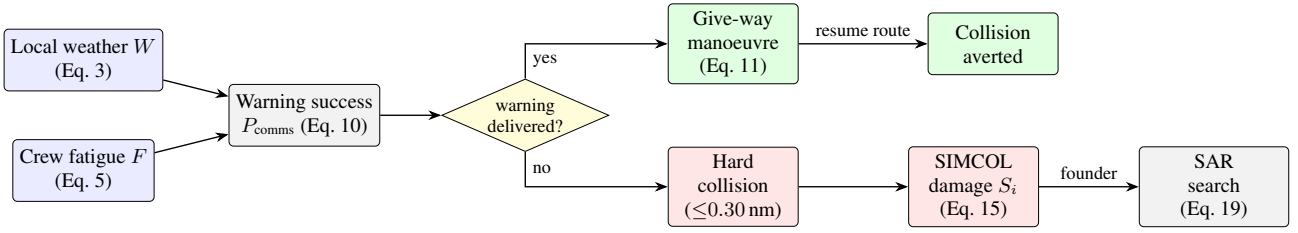


Figure 1: *Causal pipeline of the model. Local weather W and crew fatigue F jointly set the collision-warning success probability P_{comms} (Eq. 10); a delivered warning yields a give-way manoeuvre, a lost warning leaves the encounter to geometry and may produce a hard collision. Collision consequences are evaluated by the SIMCOL damage model, and a foundering vessel enters the search-and-rescue chain.*

KPIs defined in Table 2.

Falsifiable hypotheses. They drive all design decisions; any component that contributes to none of them is excluded.

- H1.** Fatigue-aware scheduling (Proposed) reduces the fatal-event rate (Table 2, KPI 1) by $\geq 20\%$ versus Baseline A ($p < 0.05$, Mann–Whitney U, Cliff’s $|\delta| \geq 0.2$).
- H2.** Earlier, better-coordinated avoidance and a functioning rescue chain improve post-incident survival (Table 2, KPI 4) by $\geq 15\%$ versus Baseline A.
- H3.** The Proposed System outperforms Baseline B on the fatal-event rate ($p < 0.05$) under the storm-corridor scenario, where comms degradation is most severe.

3. System Model

3.1. World Geometry and Projection

The simulation occupies the real Baltic and North Sea basin, bounded by latitude $\phi \in [50.5^\circ, 66.0^\circ]$ N and longitude $\lambda \in [-5.0^\circ, 31.0^\circ]$ E — from the English Channel and Dutch coast in the south-west to the Gulf of Finland in the east and the mid-Norwegian coast in the north. The domain is mapped with an equirectangular projection carrying a cosine-of-mid-latitude correction, so that one field unit equals exactly one nautical mile on both axes at the reference parallel $\phi_0 = \frac{1}{2}(\phi_{\min} + \phi_{\max}) = 58.25^\circ$. With $k_{\text{lat}} = 60 \text{ nm}/^\circ$ and $k_{\text{lon}} = 60 \cos \phi_0$, a geodetic point projects to field coordinates

$$x = (\lambda - \lambda_{\min}) k_{\text{lon}}, \quad y = (\phi - \phi_{\min}) k_{\text{lat}}. \quad (1)$$

The domain measures 930 nm north–south ($15.5^\circ \times 60$) and ≈ 1136 nm east–west; the residual east–west distortion is at most ~ 6 – 10% at the box edges and is accepted without correction terms, so the engine treats all distances as Euclidean nautical miles. The coastline is loaded from Natural-Earth polygons into an R-tree spatial index supporting accelerated point-in-polygon (land) and segment-intersection (grounding) tests.

3.2. Time Resolution

Time advances in discrete ticks of $\Delta t = 15 \text{ min}$ (0.25 h). The default horizon is $T = 2880$ ticks (30 days). A wall-clock-of-day variable, initialised at 06:00 UTC, advances 0.25 h per tick and drives the circadian fatigue term (Section 4). All stochastic draws use a single per-run seeded generator (SmallRng), so identical seeds reproduce byte-identical KPI logs.

3.3. Agent Types and Voyage Logic

The model contains vessel agents and, on incident, rescue agents (Section 8). Each vessel i carries position $\mathbf{p}_i$, an ordered route $R_i = (\mathbf{w}_0, \dots, \mathbf{w}_{m-1})$ of waypoints, a route index and travel direction $d_i \in \{+1, -1\}$, heading ψ_i , cruise speed v_i , a discrete state $\sigma_i \in \{\text{ACTIVE}, \text{DOCKED}\}$, crew count $n_i = 10$, and an internal fatigue scalar $F_i \in [0, 1]$.

Routes are *hand-authored* ordered key-point polylines drawn in a browser-based editor (`tools/waypoint-editor.html`) and stored as `data/ais_paths.json` with schema `mmsi/name/vessel_type/waypoints[]`. Fixing the lane geometry by hand — rather than replaying raw AIS — gives a controlled, reproducible traffic substrate for the information-quality experiment while preserving realistic basin-scale routing. Ports are likewise hand-authored polygons (`data/ports.json`); a vessel that enters a port polygon docks.

Cruise speed is drawn at spawn by vessel type ($u \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 1)$):

$$v_i = \begin{cases} 15 + 8u & \text{passenger / ferry / ro-ro / ro-pax} \\ 10 + 4u & \text{tanker} \\ 10 + 6u & \text{cargo / container / bulk} \\ 10 + 10u & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (2)$$

Waypoint pursuit. With active target $\mathbf{t}$ (an avoidance waypoint if queued, else the current route waypoint), $\delta = \mathbf{t} - \mathbf{p}_i$ and $\rho = \|\delta\|$, a waypoint is reached when $\rho < 0.5 \text{ nm}$. The per-tick step is $s = \min(v_i \Delta t, \rho)$ and the proposed move is $\mathbf{p}'_i = \mathbf{p}_i + (\delta/\rho)s$, with compass heading $\psi_i = (90^\circ - \text{atan2}(\delta_y, \delta_x)) \bmod 360^\circ$. To prevent tunnelling through thin landmasses, the move is accepted at the first of up to five geometrically halved step lengths $s \cdot 2^{-j}$ ($j = 0, \dots, 4$) whose segment does not cross land; a post-move grounding guard reverts $\mathbf{p}_i$ to the last valid position if it ended on land. On reaching a port or route endpoint a vessel docks for a randomised dwell $D \sim \mathcal{U}\{8, 48\}$ ticks, then reverses ($d_i \leftarrow -d_i$). A fixed fleet size N is maintained: when $|\text{fleet}| < N$, a fresh vessel is spawned onto a random hand-authored track.

3.4. Weather and Hazard Field

A 50×50 -cell grid evolves three physical channels — sea state s , visibility v , and wind u , each in $[0, 1]$ — which are fused into a scalar hazard $W_{ij} \in [0, 1]$:

$$W = \text{clip} \left(\frac{w_s s + w_v (1 - v) + w_u u}{w_s + w_v + w_u}, 0, 1 \right), \quad (3)$$

with weights $(w_s, w_v, w_u) = (1.0, 0.5, 0.8)$. A vessel samples W at its current cell only (nearest-cell lookup), so each vessel acts on local conditions. The field advances each tick through seven ordered stages (full parameters in Section 10.4): (i) a two-state calm/storm regime Markov chain selecting mean-reversion targets; (ii) up to eight Lagrangian storm cells with growth, decay, drift and removal; (iii) an AR(1)-with-advection background per channel; (iv) a system overlay imprinting storm cells onto the channels; (v) cross-channel coupling; (vi) 5-point smoothing with a gradient limiter; and (vii) hazard fusion via Eq. 3.

Independently of the stochastic field, the **storm corridor** scenario carries a single moving storm zone of radius r_{storm} that drifts at 0.30 nm/tick along a fixed lat/lon track (English Channel $\rightarrow$ North Sea $\rightarrow$ Skagerrak $\rightarrow$ Kattegat $\rightarrow$ Baltic $\rightarrow$ Gdańsk). Inside the zone, both communication reliability (Section 5) and vessel speed (Section 10.3) are degraded.

4. Crew Fatigue Dynamics

Each vessel carries an internal fatigue scalar $F_i \in [0, 1]$ (0 rested, 1 exhausted), updated every tick. The circadian drive peaks near 03:00 and troughs near 15:00:

$$c(t_{\text{utc}}) = \frac{1}{2} \left(1 - \cos \left(\frac{2\pi(t_{\text{utc}} - 3)}{24} \right) \right) \in [0, 1]. \quad (4)$$

While ACTIVE, with local hazard W , fatigue accumulates as

$$\Delta F = (\beta_{\text{base}} + \beta_W W + \beta_c c(t_{\text{utc}})) m(\text{method}), \quad (5)$$

with $(\beta_{\text{base}}, \beta_W, \beta_c) = (0.0015, 0.0040, 0.0008)$ and a method build-rate

$$m(\text{method}) = \begin{cases} 1.00 & \text{Baseline A (unmanaged)} \\ 0.82 & \text{Baseline B (shore rest alerts)} \\ 0.65 & \text{Proposed (smart scheduling),} \end{cases} \quad (6)$$

and $F_i \leftarrow \min(1, F_i + \Delta F)$. While DOKED, the crew recovers at $F_i \leftarrow \max(0, F_i - 0.025)$ per tick (full recovery in ≈ 40 ticks). The method factor m is the sole lever distinguishing the three conditions' human-factor behaviour, isolating the effect of fatigue management.

Fatigue $\rightarrow$ communication degradation. Tired watchkeepers miss or delay warnings. With threshold $F^* = 0.40$ and maximum penalty $\kappa = 0.65$,

$$g(F_i) = \begin{cases} 1, & F_i \leq F^* \\ 1 - \kappa \frac{F_i - F^*}{1 - F^*}, & F_i > F^* \end{cases} \in [0.35, 1]. \quad (7)$$

This factor multiplies into the collision-warning success probability (Eq. 10), the mechanism through which fatigue translates into collisions.

5. Collision Avoidance

5.1. CPA / TCPA Detection

Each ACTIVE pair is screened with the standard linear-motion closest-point-of-approach result. The field-frame velocity for heading ψ and speed v is $\mathbf{v}(\psi, v) = v \Delta t (\sin \psi, \cos \psi)$. For a pair (a, b) with relative position $\Delta \mathbf{p} = \mathbf{p}_b - \mathbf{p}_a$ and relative velocity $\Delta \mathbf{v} = \mathbf{v}_b - \mathbf{v}_a$,

$$t^* = -\frac{\Delta \mathbf{p} \cdot \Delta \mathbf{v}}{\|\Delta \mathbf{v}\|^2}, \quad d_{\text{CPA}} = \|\Delta \mathbf{p} + t^* \Delta \mathbf{v}\|, \quad (8)$$

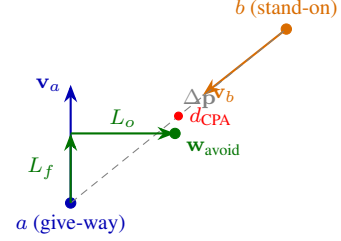


Figure 2: Give-way geometry. The lower-id vessel a turns to starboard toward a temporary waypoint $\mathbf{w}_{\text{avoid}}$ placed L_f ahead and L_o to starboard of its heading (Eq. 11), opening the closest-point-of-approach distance d_{CPA} to the stand-on vessel b . The manoeuvre executes only if the warning is delivered (Eq. 10).

with t^* measured in ticks. Degenerate cases return $(d_{\text{CPA}}, t^*) = (\|\Delta \mathbf{p}\|, \infty)$ when $\|\Delta \mathbf{v}\|^2 < 10^{-9}$ (parallel) and $(\|\Delta \mathbf{p}\|, 0)$ when $t^* \leq 0$ (diverging). A manoeuvre is considered iff all of

$$\|\Delta \mathbf{p}\| \leq 20 \text{ nm}, \quad d_{\text{CPA}} \leq 5 \text{ nm}, \quad 0 < t^* \leq 12 \text{ ticks}, \quad (9)$$

hold and the give-way vessel is not in avoidance cooldown.

5.2. Give-Way Rule and Communication Success

The vessel with the lower identifier is the give-way (turn-to-starboard) vessel; the other stands on. A deterministic lower-id rule is a reproducible surrogate for the COLREGs crossing/head-on stand-on/give-way assignment [4, 5]. Crucially, the manoeuvre is executed *only if the warning is successfully communicated*, with success probability the product of an environmental factor and a fatigue factor over both vessels:

$$P_{\text{comms}} = \underbrace{\min(q(\mathbf{p}_a), q(\mathbf{p}_b))}_{\text{weather / storm}} \cdot \underbrace{\min(g(F_a), g(F_b))}_{\text{fatigue, Eq. 7}}, \quad (10)$$

where $q(\mathbf{p})$ is the nominal link reliability, reduced to the storm-comms rate (as low as 0.08 inside the storm corridor — 92 % of warnings lost) when $\mathbf{p}$ lies in the storm zone. The manoeuvre proceeds iff a uniform draw is below P_{comms} ; otherwise the give-way vessel fails to act, leaving the encounter to resolve by geometry alone. Equation 10 is the model's central coupling: it makes warning delivery jointly contingent on weather and human fatigue.

5.3. Avoidance Geometry and Message Exchange

A give-way vessel receives one temporary waypoint placed $L_f = 3$ nm ahead and $L_o = 5$ nm to starboard of its heading ψ (Fig. 2):

$$\mathbf{w}_{\text{avoid}} = \mathbf{p} + L_f (\sin \psi, \cos \psi) + L_o (\cos \psi, -\sin \psi). \quad (11)$$

A three-message exchange is logged — `CollisionWarning{cpa,tta}` $\rightarrow$ `GivingWay` $\rightarrow$ `MaintainingCourse`, with `ResumeRoute` once the avoidance waypoint is consumed. Each issued warning records its t^* for the average-TTA KPI, and a 3-tick cooldown prevents manoeuvre thrashing.

5.4. Optional Continuous-Avoidance Track (Force Field)

As an optional realism layer, the discrete give-way waypoint of Eq. 11 can be replaced by a continuous artificial-force-field manoeuvre in the style of Xiao et al. [10], in which COLREGs behaviour emerges rather than being scripted. A vessel responds

to a repulsive force from each nearby obstacle (vessel or shoal) within an effect distance d_o ,

$$\mathbf{F}_{\text{rep}} = \sum_{k: d_k < d_o} \frac{k_{\text{rep}}}{d_k^2} \hat{\mathbf{n}}_k, \quad (12)$$

where d_k is the distance to obstacle k , $\hat{\mathbf{n}}_k$ the unit vector away from it, and k_{rep} a steepness constant. The resultant force sets a rudder angle that drives a first-order Nomoto manoeuvring response with non-dimensional indices $K' = K(L/v)$, $T' = T(v/L)$. The effect distance is calibrated from AIS encounter statistics, with $d_o \sim \mathcal{N}(1548, 706^2)$ m for head-on and $\mathcal{N}(384, 358^2)$ m for overtaking encounters [10]. In this track, the crew-preparedness state scales k_{rep} , so a fatigued crew yields weaker, later avoidance.

6. Collision Consequence Model (SIMCOL)

A **hard collision** is logged whenever two ACTIVE vessels close within $d_{\text{hit}} = 2 r_{\text{coll}} = 0.30$ nm. The consequence of a hard collision is evaluated with the DTU SIMCOL probabilistic damage and survivability model [11], which replaces an ad-hoc casualty rule with collision mechanics.

External dynamics. The energy released for hull deformation is the loss of kinetic energy of the rigid-body system between first contact and the common-velocity state, evaluated with the closed-form external-dynamics solution of Pedersen and Zhang [12] as used by Lützen [11, 13]. Only the component of the closing velocity *normal* to the struck vessel's side performs side-penetrating work, so for struck and striking displacements M_a , M_b the absorbed energy is the reduced-mass energy on that normal component,

$$E_{\text{abs}} = \frac{1}{2} \frac{M'_a M'_b}{M'_a + M'_b} V_n^2, \quad V_n = |(\mathbf{v}_b - \mathbf{v}_a) \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}}|, \quad (13)$$

where $\hat{\mathbf{n}}$ is the unit normal to the struck side and $M'_a = M_a(1 + m_{\text{sway}})$, $M'_b = M_b(1 + m_{\text{surge}})$ carry hydrodynamic added mass with sway coefficient $m_{\text{sway}} = 0.85$ and surge coefficient $m_{\text{surge}} = 0.05$ [11]. The normal-velocity projection V_n supplies the collision-angle dependence directly — a near-parallel graze releases almost no energy while a perpendicular impact releases the maximum — so Eq. 13 reduces to the classical right-angle reduced-mass form when $\hat{\mathbf{n}}$ aligns with the closing velocity, and no separate oblique-reduction factor is required.

Internal mechanics. The absorbed energy is related to damage extent through Minorsky's absorbed-energy/resistance-volume correlation [14], $E_{\text{abs}} [\text{MJ}] = 47.2 R_T + 32.7$, where R_T is the resistance (destroyed) volume of deformed structural material. Lützen casts the resulting damage as *non-dimensional* distributions — the damage length ℓ/L_{pp} (longitudinal extent normalised by struck-ship length) and the penetration t/B (transverse extent normalised by breadth), each fitted to striking-ship displacement, speed, and collision angle [11]. Taking a representative damage length $\ell = 0.12 L_{pp}$ (the median of that distribution) and an effective smeared side-steel thickness $\tau = 0.08$ m, the breach penetration is $t = R_T/(\ell \tau)$, expressed non-dimensionally as t/B .

Survivability. Because the engine does not carry per-ship residual-stability curves, the survivability factor $S_i \in [0, 1]$ — the conditional probability that the struck vessel survives the flooding case — is modelled as a SOLAS II-1-shaped surro-

gate [15] on the relative penetration:

$$S_i = \begin{cases} 1, & t/B \leq r_0 \\ \left(\frac{r_1 - t/B}{r_1 - r_0} \right)^{0.25}, & r_0 < t/B < r_1 \\ 0, & t/B \geq r_1, \end{cases} \quad (14)$$

with knee $r_0 = 0.10$, full-loss penetration $r_1 = 0.30$, and the 0.25 exponent of the SOLAS II-1 *s*-factor. The per-collision expected fatalities are then

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{fatalities}] = n_b (1 - S_i), \quad (15)$$

with n_b the struck-ship crew, drawn as a per-crew Bernoulli trial; each colliding vessel is evaluated independently as the struck ship. A vessel whose survival factor falls below the founder threshold $S^\dagger = 0.50$ founders, triggering evacuation and the search-and-rescue chain (Section 8); $S_i \rightarrow 1$ is logged as a near-miss damage event.

7. External Collision-Frequency Validation (IWRAP)

The internal KPIs (Section 9) measure relative differences between methods but are not, by themselves, regulator-grade frequencies. To anchor the model to accepted practice, each run's vessel tracks are exported as synthetic AIS and analysed offline with the IWRAP Mk II model [16]. The expected number of collisions on a waterway is the product of a geometric candidate count and a causation probability [17, 16]:

$$N_c = N_a P_c. \quad (16)$$

For two opposing flows of classes i, j over a leg of sailing distance D and fairway width W during time t , the head-on candidate count is

$$N_a^{\text{head}} = \frac{D t}{W} \sum_{i,j} Q_i^{(1)} Q_j^{(2)} \frac{(B_i^{(1)} + B_j^{(2)}) (V_i^{(1)} + V_j^{(2)})}{V_i^{(1)} V_j^{(2)}}, \quad (17)$$

with traffic flows Q , beams B , speeds V ; the overtaking form replaces $(V_i + V_j)$ with $|V_i - V_j|$. For crossing waterways meeting at angle $\Theta \in (10^\circ, 170^\circ)$,

$$N_a^{\text{cross}} = \sum_{i,j} Q_i^{(1)} Q_j^{(2)} \frac{D_{ij} V_{ij}}{V_i^{(1)} V_j^{(2)}} \frac{1}{\sin \Theta}, \quad (18)$$

where $V_{ij} = \sqrt{(V_i^{(1)})^2 + (V_j^{(2)})^2 - 2 V_i^{(1)} V_j^{(2)} \cos \Theta}$ is the relative speed and D_{ij} the Pedersen collision diameter [16, 13]. The causation probabilities are the IWRAP software defaults [16, 17]: $P_c^{\text{head-on}} = 0.50 \times 10^{-4}$, $P_c^{\text{overtaking}} = 1.10 \times 10^{-4}$, and $P_c^{\text{crossing}} = 1.30 \times 10^{-4}$. An offline analyzer builds the leg network from the hand-authored routes, derives per-leg flows from the fleet and traversal times, and sums the head-on, overtaking, and crossing contributions into a per-year N_c . For the present network this yields $N_c \approx 0.01$ collisions/yr, within the regulator acceptance of <1 collision/yr/fairway; comparing N_c between Baseline A and the Proposed System (whose weather-aware slow-down lowers traffic flow) provides an externally interpretable, regulator-aligned check that the fatigue-coupling mechanism produces frequency reductions of the expected order.

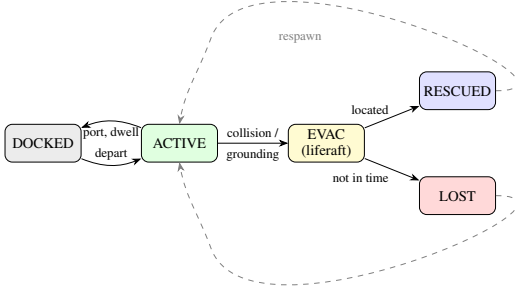


Figure 3: *Vessel state machine.* A vessel cycles ACTIVE $\leftrightarrow$ DOCKED along its route; a foundering collision or grounding sends it to EVAC (liferaft), from which the SAR chain yields RESCUED (search detection, Eq. 19) or LOST (the survivors are not located before the liferaft survival window elapses). Terminal vessels respawn to maintain fleet size.

8. Search-and-Rescue Subsystem

When a collision founders a vessel (Eq. 15, $S_i < S_i^\dagger$) or a grounding forces an evacuation, the survivors enter a liferaft and the search-and-rescue (SAR) chain is triggered. A rescue agent is dispatched from the nearest shore base (a port) after a mobilisation delay $\Delta t_{\text{mob}} = 2$ ticks — a helicopter (80 kn) when the datum lies beyond 40 nm offshore, otherwise a patrol vessel (25 kn) [18]. The asset then progresses through mobilise, transit, search, and embark phases; the subsystem layers two accredited components onto this transit. Figure 3 shows the resulting vessel state machine.

8.1. Drift and Random-Search Detection (MASSIM)

Because the exact distress position is uncertain and the liferaft drifts, detection is modelled with the Koopman random-search formulation used in the MASSIM maritime-search model [19, 20]. A searcher of sweep width w moving at speed v_s over a search area A has instantaneous detection rate $\gamma(t) = w v_s / A$. The cumulative detection probability for n searchers over elapsed search time τ is

$$\text{CDP} = 1 - \exp\left(-\frac{n w v_s \tau}{A}\right) = 1 - e^{-C}, \quad (19)$$

where $C = n w v_s \tau / A$ is the search coverage factor and v_s the asset’s (season-degraded, Section 8.2) on-scene speed. The search area expands as the datum drifts: with an initial uncertainty radius r_0 and drift speed u_d , the area grows as $A(\tau) = \pi (r_0 + u_d \tau)^2$, so detection becomes harder the longer the response is delayed — the quantitative link from response latency to survival. Each on-scene tick advects the liferaft datum along the prevailing current and draws a Bernoulli detection at the per-tick coverage $1 - e^{-dC}$ [19].

8.2. Environmental Degradation (Ashrafi)

Rescue-asset performance degrades with season following the Arctic SAR framework of Ashrafi et al. [21], in which air temperature, wind speed, significant wave height, and a wind-chill index combine into a per-month severity. The wind-chill index

uses the standard form

$$\text{wci} = 13.12 + 0.6215 T - 11.37 U^{0.16} + 0.3965 T U^{0.16}, \quad (20)$$

with air temperature T ($^{\circ}\text{C}$) and wind speed U (km/h). Rather than re-deriving the expert-assigned metocean thresholds, we adopt the framework’s published month-group aggregation: each calendar month maps to one of four severity groups — A (May–August, mildest), B (April, September), C (March, October, November), and D (January, February, December, harshest) [21]. The group multiplicatively reduces the asset’s transit and search speed — helicopter 1.00/0.95/0.77/0.60 and patrol vessel 1.00/0.80/0.40/0.21 for groups A–D, relative to the mildest group — and sets the per-survivor boarding time (2.1–10.7 min by helicopter, 6.1–31.2 min by vessel) [21]. On location, the asset embarks the n_b survivors at this season-degraded rate before the case is logged RESCUED. Transit, search (Eq. 19), and boarding therefore all lengthen in winter, so — reproducing the source case study — the longest rescue times occur December–February and the shortest May–August [21].

9. Experimental Design

9.1. Methods Under Test

The three conditions of Section 2 are realised as configuration switches over one agent codebase:

- **Baseline A (Classical):** weather-unaware; idealised VHF ($q \equiv 1$); no weather-induced slowdown; unmanaged fatigue ($m = 1.00$); collision-consequence multiplier highest.
- **Baseline B (Shore Rest Alerts):** weather-aware slowdown (Section 10.3); reduced fatigue build-rate ($m = 0.82$); weather/storm-gated comms.
- **Proposed System:** smart watch scheduling ($m = 0.65$) plus all Baseline B mitigations.

9.2. Scenarios

Table 1 summarises the four scenarios; each runs 30 independent seeds for 2880 ticks (30 days). With three methods and four scenarios, the full plan executes $4 \times 3 \times 30 = 360$ runs, dispatched in parallel.

9.3. Key Performance Indicators

Table 2 defines the six KPIs. Ship-hours accumulate 0.25 h per ACTIVE vessel per tick.

Crew preparedness (KPI 6) is accumulated each tick for every ACTIVE vessel as the product of a weather-readiness and a fatigue-readiness term, with method awareness factor $\alpha_M \in \{2.0 \text{ (A)}, 1.3 \text{ (B)}, 1.0 \text{ (Proposed)}\}$:

$$P_{\text{prep}} = \max(0, 1 - \alpha_M W) \cdot \max(0, 1 - 0.70 F). \quad (21)$$

9.4. Statistical Analysis

For every (KPI $\times$ scenario $\times$ method-pair), the two methods are compared with a two-tailed Mann–Whitney U test (average-rank tie handling, normal approximation): with $\mu_U = n_1 n_2 / 2$, $\sigma_U = \sqrt{n_1 n_2 (n_1 + n_2 + 1) / 12}$, $z = (U - \mu_U) / \sigma_U$, and $p = 2\Phi(-|z|)$, where Φ is evaluated by the Abramowitz–Stegun 26.2.17 rational approximation. The effect size is Cliff’s $\delta = (U_1 - U_2) / (n_1 n_2) \in [-1, 1]$ [22]. Multiplicity is controlled by Holm–Bonferroni step-down over all tests; a result is *significant* if $p_{\text{corr}} < 0.05$ and *confirmed* if additionally

Table 1: *Scenario summary. All scenarios use 30 seeds and 2880 ticks/run (30 days at 15 min/tick).*

Scenario	Key conditions	Ships	Hyp.
1 — Calm Passage	calm-biased weather; nominal comms. Calibration target <0.5 collisions / 1 k ship-hrs.	20	Calib.
2 — Storm Corridor	moving storm zone; comms rate as low as 0.08 inside.	25	H1, H3
3 — Blind Shore	reduced fleet; degraded coordination away from dense lanes.	25	H1
4 — Deep Water Rescue	sparse fleet; long rescue transits stress the SAR chain.	15	H2

Table 2: *KPI definitions and hypothesis links.*

#	KPI	Definition	Hyp.
1	<code>fatal_per_1k_hrs</code>	Fatalities $\div$ ship-hrs $\times 10^3$	H1
2	<code>collision_per_1k_hrs</code>	Collisions $\div$ ship-hrs $\times 10^3$	H1
3	<code>evac_activation_rate</code>	Evac activations $\div$ ship-hrs $\times 10^3$	H1
4	<code>survival_ratio</code>	1 — fatalities / crew exposed in collisions	H2
5	<code>avg_tta_hours</code>	Mean rescue Time-to-Arrival across dispatches	H2
6	<code>mean_p_prep</code>	Time-averaged crew preparedness across vessels	H1, H3

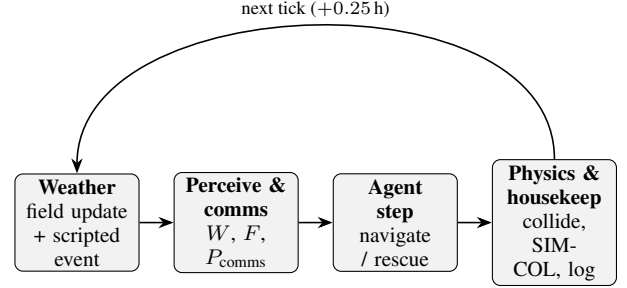


Figure 4: *The four ordered phases of each 15-minute macro tick. Data flows strictly left to right within a tick; weather precedes perception so a vessel acts on the field issued in the same tick, and physics/housekeeping closes the tick before the clock advances.*

$|\delta| \geq 0.2$. Method pairs tested are (A vs Proposed), (B vs Proposed), and (A vs B). The same seed sequence is applied to all conditions, eliminating seed-selection bias from pairwise comparisons.

10. Implementation

10.1. Engine and Execution

The model is implemented in Rust on the krABMaga agent-based framework [9], with an axum/tokio REST + Web-Socket server for live run control and a rayon-parallel batch runner; a React/Leaflet frontend renders vessels, ports, the storm zone, the weather grid, the comms log, and KPIs live. Batch runs write per-run JSONL tick logs, a manifest, and a `summary.csv` for analysis. Vessel agents are scheduled at krABMaga ordering 200 and a single post-tick agent at ordering 1000.

10.2. Simulation Loop

Each macro tick runs four ordered phases (Fig. 4) whose ordering is a causal constraint: (1) *weather* — advance the field and apply any scenario-scripted event; (2) *perception & communication* — each vessel samples local hazard, updates fatigue (Eqs. 4–7), and CPA-screened encounters attempt their warning exchange (Eq. 10); (3) *agent step* — vessels navigate at hazard-gated speed (Section 10.3) or hold for avoidance, and rescue agents decrement mobilisation or advance under the SAR penalty (Section 8); (4) *physics & housekeeping* — hard-collision and grounding checks, SIMCOL consequence evaluation (Section 6), terminal-vessel respawn, logging, and clock advance.

10.3. Speed Reduction under Hazard

Two multiplicative slow-downs are applied by interpolating the just-moved position back toward the last valid position by a factor f . The hazard-gated factor (Baseline B and Proposed only; Baseline A ignores weather) is

$$f_W = \max(0.30, 1 - 0.45 W), \quad (22)$$

and a storm-zone factor $f_{\text{storm}} \in \{1.0 \text{ (A)}, 0.45 \text{ (storm corridor)}, 0.70 \text{ (default)}\}$ damps speed inside the moving zone, acting as an implicit braking mechanism that lowers closing rates in deteriorating weather.

10.4. Weather Process Parameters

The seven-stage field of Section 3.4 uses: regime flip probabilities $p_{cs} = 0.03$, $p_{sc} = 0.08$ (Mixed preset; scaled $\times (0.35, 1.40)$ Calm, $\times (2.00, 0.50)$ Stormy); reversion targets Calm(0.30, 0.80, 0.25) / Storm(0.72, 0.30, 0.75); up to $K_{\max} = 8$ storm cells with intensity decay $\tau \in \{0.006 \text{ storm}, 0.020 \text{ calm}\}$, radius $r = 8(1 + 0.15 \sin \theta)\sqrt{I}$, and removal at $I < 0.12$; an AR(1) background

$$X_{t+1} = \rho_X \text{adv}(X_t) + (1 - \rho_X) \mu_X + \sigma_X (0.3 + u) \eta_t, \quad (23)$$

with $(\rho_s, \rho_v, \rho_u) = (0.95, 0.90, 0.93)$, $(\sigma_s, \sigma_v, \sigma_u) = (0.07, 0.06, 0.07)$, unpredictability $u = 0.30$, and $\eta \sim \mathcal{U}(-1, 1)$; a system overlay $\omega = (1 - \sqrt{d^2/r^2})^2 I$ adding to s, u and subtracting 0.85ω from v ; cross-channel coupling $s \pm = 0.35(u - 0.5) - 0.20(v - 0.5)$, $u \pm = 0.25(v - 0.5)$; and a 5-point smoother with gradient cap $G_{\max} = 0.12$.

11. Discussion

The model's defensible core is the explicit, quantified coupling in Eq. 10: a single collision-warning exchange succeeds only when both the environment and both crews permit it. This makes the central hypotheses (H1–H3) mechanistic rather than correlational — fatigue management (m in Eq. 6) acts on outcomes solely by changing how often warnings are delivered and how prepared crews are, with no other lever distinguishing the conditions. Re-baselining the report on the real Baltic–North Sea engine, with hand-authored tracks and manual ports, keeps the experiment controlled while remaining geographically realistic.

The accredited layers raise the model from an internal A/B comparison toward external validity. SIMCOL (Section 6) grounds casualty counts in collision mechanics rather than a tunable rate; IWRAP (Section 7) places the resulting frequencies on a regulator-recognised scale; and the SAR subsystem (Section 8) makes `survival_ratio` and `avg_tta_hours` meaningful by modelling drift, random-search detection, and environmental degradation rather than instantaneous rescue. The SIMCOL external dynamics are pinned to the Pedersen–Zhang closed form, with the absorbed energy carried by the normal closing-velocity component and Lützen's added-mass coefficients (Eq. 13); the only modelling surrogate in the consequence chain is the survival factor S_i (Eq. 14), shaped to the SOLAS II-1 s -factor because the engine does not resolve per-ship residual stability. The SAR environmental degradation is likewise pinned to Ashrafi's published month-group constants (Section 8.2); the single remaining TODO–VERIFY marker is the optional force-field repulsion exponent (Section 5.4), to be pinned against its source before final reporting.

Limitations follow from the controlled design. Hand-authored tracks trade empirical traffic realism for reproducibility; the deterministic lower-id give-way rule is a simplification of full COLREGs assignment; and the optional force-field track (Section 5.4) is not the default. Calibration targets — notably fewer than 0.5 collisions per 1 000 ship-hours under Baseline A in the Calm Passage scenario — are grounded in AIS-derived near-miss encounter statistics [6, 7].

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A. Default Constants Reference

Table 3 lists the principal engine constants with default values; all are overridable via `SimulationConfig` or the dashboard.

Table 3: *Selected engine default constants.*

Constant	Default	Role
Δt	0.25 h	tick length (15 min)
T	2880	ticks per run (30 d)
weather grid	50×50	hazard field
(w_s, w_v, w_u)	(1.0, 0.5, 0.8)	hazard fusion weights
warn / CPA / TTA gate	20 / 5 nm / 12 tk	avoidance gate
L_f, L_o	3 / 5 nm	give-way waypoint offsets
cooldown	3 tk	re-manoeuvre
r_{coll}	0.15 nm	lockout
$(m_{\text{sway}}, m_{\text{surge}})$	0.85, 0.05	hit at $2r = 0.30$ nm
Minorsky a, b	47.2, 32.7	SIMCOL added mass
$\ell / L_{pp}, \tau$	0.12, 0.08 m	energy-volume (MJ, m ³)
$r_0, r_1, S^\dagger$	0.10, 0.30, 0.50	damage length / side steel
$(\beta_{\text{base}}, \beta_W, \beta_c)$	0.0015, 0.0040, 0.0008	S_i knee / loss / founder
recovery	0.025/tk	fatigue rates
F^*, κ	0.40, 0.65	dock fatigue recovery
storm comms rate	0.08	comms-degradation
n crew dwell	10	knee
helicopter / patrol	8–48 tk 80 / 25 kn	corridor link reliability
Δt_{mob}	2 tk	per vessel port stay
helo / patrol cutoff	40 nm	rescue asset speeds
w, r_0, u_d	5 nm, 2 nm, 0.2 nm/tk	rescue mobilisation delay
survival window	96 tk	SAR asset-selection datum range
P_c (IWRAP)	$0.5\text{--}1.3 \times 10^{-4}$	MASSIM sweep / datum / drift
		liferaft endurance (24 h)
		causation probability